CCT TECH HELP

10-Minute Small Business Security Checklist

Ten quick checks, about one minute each. Tick them off.

Hi, I'm Alex, with a background in cybersecurity running Collar City Tech Help from Troy, NY. These ten checks cover the problems I hear about most from small business owners. You do not need to be technical. Do them in order: the first few matter most.

☐ 1. Turn on two-step login for your business email

Email is the key to everything else, because password resets go there. In Gmail, Google Workspace or Microsoft 365, open the security settings and turn on 2-step verification (an authenticator app is better than text messages). Do the owner account first.

☐ 2. Stop reusing passwords, starting with email

Your email password should be long and used nowhere else. A password manager remembers the rest for you. Change the email password first, then banking, then everything that holds customer information.

☐ 3. Switch on automatic updates

On every computer and phone that touches the business: Windows Update or macOS Software Update set to automatic, plus browser and phone updates. Old software is a common way in.

☐ 4. Check that your backup really ran

Open your backup tool and look for a success date within the last week. Keep one copy away from the computer (cloud or an unplugged drive). Then restore one file to prove it works.

☐ 5. List who has access, and remove people who left

Write down who can log in to your email, website, social pages, Google Business Profile and payment accounts. Remove former staff, past web designers and shared logins that nobody needs.

☐ 6. Use the 'call first' rule for invoices and bank changes

Before paying a new or changed invoice, or changing bank details, call the person at a number you already had. Do not use the phone number or link in the message.

☐ 7. Lock every device

Set a screen lock and passcode on each computer, phone and tablet. Turn on device encryption (BitLocker on Windows, FileVault on Mac, built-in on modern phones) so a lost laptop is not a lost customer list.

☐ 8. Tidy up your Wi-Fi

Change the router's default admin password. Put customers and guests on a separate guest network. Use WPA2 or WPA3 and a password that is not on a sticky note by the register.

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- [ ] **9. Ask whether your email domain is protected**

  Three public settings called SPF, DKIM and DMARC help stop scammers from faking email that looks like it came from your business. Ask your email host or web provider if they are set up. (Our Security Scorecard checks these for you.)

- [ ] **10. Write a one-page 'if something goes wrong' note**

  Who to call, where your logins and recovery codes are kept, how to freeze a card, and the first three accounts to secure. A calm plan written today beats a panic later.

Want to know how you scored? Two ways to find out:

1. Free: the 3-minute quiz at collarcitytechhelp.com/#quiz (ten yes/no questions, instant score).
2. $79 Security Scorecard: a written report with your grade, top 5 risks and an ordered fix list.

Full refund within 7 days. We never ask for passwords and never log in to your systems.

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